IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

# IELTS Academic Set 36

## PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

## Listening

| Question | Answer | Accepted variants |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Devereux | |
| 2 | home office | |
| 3 | west | |
| 4 | 184 | |
| 5 | 23 February | 23rd February, February 23, February 23rd |
| 6 | sample | |
| 7 | late afternoon | |
| 8 | garden | |
| 9 | neutral film | neutral |
| 10 | glass condition | |
| 11 | C | |
| 12 | F | |
| 13 | A | |
| 14 | H | |
| 15 | D | |
| 16 | B | |
| 17 | B | |
| 18 | D | |
| 19 | A | |

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| Question | Answer | Accepted variants |
|---|---|---|
| 20 | C | |
| 21 | B | |
| 22 | C | |
| 23 | B | |
| 24 | A | |
| 25 | C | |
| 26 | call number | |
| 27 | prompt | |
| 28 | aisle | |
| 29 | difficulty | |
| 30 | order | |
| 31 | atmosphere | |
| 32 | polarisation | |
| 33 | photoreceptors | |
| 34 | compass | |
| 35 | cloud cover | |
| 36 | clock | |
| 37 | D | |
| 38 | A | |
| 39 | C | |
| 40 | E | |

## Listening transcript

### Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Good morning, ClearView consultations. We assess whether an interior window film suits a particular pane and use. To open the booking, could I confirm your surname? |
| **Ffion Devereux** | It is Devereux, D-E-V-E-R-E-U-X, rather than the shorter spelling on the web enquiry. Please use Devereux on the appointment. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Thank you. Which room are we assessing? You can mention another room for future work, but this consultation needs one main window. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | The troublesome window is in the home office. The bedroom may need privacy later, but it is not part of this visit. |

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Hamish Cleeve** | And which direction does the office window face? That helps us bring samples suited to the time of day when the strongest light reaches the glass. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | It faces west, which is why the strongest sun reaches it later in the day rather than first thing in the morning. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Could you give me the approximate frame-opening width? The installer will take final pane measurements, so please do not substitute the narrower glass width. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | The frame opening is 184 centimetres wide. The glass itself is slightly narrower, but 184 is the figure for the booking. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | I can offer the twenty-third of February, between ten and noon; the twenty-second is already full. Would you like that appointment? |
| **Ffion Devereux** | Yes, please book 23 February. I work from home that morning, so the ten-to-noon arrival window is fine. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | I will bring a sample card with several films, allowing you to compare them against the actual daylight before any product is selected or bonded. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | Good. A blind makes video calls too dark, so I want to soften the light without losing the view. When should we judge the worst glare? |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Could you tell me when it usually becomes most uncomfortable? Morning brightness can look strong, but the timing in your room is what matters. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | The glare is worst in late afternoon, usually after three. It is much less troublesome during the brighter-looking morning. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Besides reducing glare, what must remain visible from your desk? A fully opaque film gives privacy but may block something you need to see. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | The garden must remain visible through the glass. Privacy is useful, but I do not want to lose that view while I am working. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | We can compare neutral and reflective products. Reflective film can look mirrored and its privacy changes after dark. Which type would you prefer to begin with? |
| **Ffion Devereux** | I prefer neutral film. I do not want the window to look mirrored, although I understand we should still compare how the samples control glare. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Before colour or final measurements, I will inspect the glass condition for cracks, seals and any previous coating. That determines whether film is suitable at all. |
| **Ffion Devereux** | That is reassuring. I will clear ornaments from the sill but leave the curtains in place so you can see how the room is normally used. |
| **Hamish Cleeve** | Exactly. I will email the date and preparation note now. The quotation will follow only after the pane is checked and you have compared the samples in the room. Please leave the curtains in their position because the adviser will compare the pane from both inside and outside. The visit should take about forty minutes, and no glass will be removed during the consultation. |

## Part 2 - everyday social monologue

| | |
|---|---|
| **Tavish Beckward** | Welcome to Pinewater Reservoir. This briefing covers the marked recreation route, the wildlife boundary and the locations available if conditions change. Check the map before launching; the recording is not a substitute for current ranger advice. |

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Tavish Beckward** | The main launch is on the south shore, beside the visitor centre and equipment check area. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | North is at the top. The visitor centre sits on the south shore. The dam occupies the south-west corner and has its own exclusion line; no recreation route enters that area. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The smaller alternative launch is on the west shore. Use it only when the main ramp is closed or a ranger directs your group there. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | Conditions can change quickly because open water channels wind along the reservoir. A sheltered inlet may reduce waves, but it does not remove the need for a buoyancy aid or group spacing. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The curved water on the eastern side is the sheltered inlet, which offers protection from a west wind. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The usual circuit travels east from the main ramp, crosses to the portage and continues north. Beginners should turn back at the inlet if the wind warning rises rather than attempting the exposed crossing. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The line of orange buoys in the north-east marks the nesting exclusion zone. Do not pass between those buoys and shore. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | Wildlife restrictions protect a seasonal nesting area. The buoys define the boundary on the water. Seeing an empty shore does not permit landing, and paddlers should not approach for photographs. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | At the narrow rocky section, leave the water and use the portage path, carrying the canoe to the marked re-entry point. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The portage avoids a narrow shallow reach containing rocks and sensitive bank vegetation. Step out at the signed landing, carry the boat on the firm path and relaunch only at the second sign. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The pale beach below the eastern ridge is the emergency landing beach. It is not a lunch stop. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | An emergency landing is marked separately because access for rescue vehicles is possible above the beach. Routine stops there could block that access. Use the radio channel printed on your permit if help is required. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | North picnic point is a normal stopping place with racks above the waterline. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | Before departure, leave a route card at the visitor centre and report when the group returns. If your route changes, update a ranger whenever communication is available. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | The emergency beach is for use only in an emergency such as injury, damaged equipment or rapidly worsening weather. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | At the nesting buoy line, no landing is permitted. Stay on the open-water side and keep noise low. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | On the portage path, carry boats on foot. Paddling the shallow channel beside it damages the bank. |

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| **Tavish Beckward** | Group leaders should count paddlers at every stop and maintain visual contact during crossings. If one boat falls behind, the leading canoe waits in sheltered water rather than continuing around a point. Weather flags at the visitor centre use green, amber and red. Amber does not automatically close the route, but it restricts beginner groups to the inlet. Red closes launches. Water temperature can remain low, so spare dry clothing travels in a sealed bag. Each canoe also carries a whistle and a painter line. These items support emergency response but do not make the dam area or wildlife zone safe to enter. At the north point, land only at the signed rack and lift boats clear of waves. The rocky shore immediately east of the point is not an alternative landing. Before entering open water, pairs should agree simple hand signals for stopping and regrouping. |
| **Tavish Beckward** | We will now check fitted buoyancy aids and group leaders. Launching begins only after every route card is complete. |

## Part 3 - educational/training discussion

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|---|---|
| **Crispin Penrith** | Eleri, the supervisor was right: our pilot compared navigation aids only on paper. In practice, participants brought prior knowledge into the task and bypassed the point where the two aids differed. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | The pilot failed mainly because participants used a familiar shortcut. They reached the shelf without relying on either information condition. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | The library catalogue assigns a call number, but locating a book also requires interpreting floors, zones, aisles and shelf order. We should study the route without implying that one sign solves every stage. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | We cannot exclude every student, but we can use a less familiar floor where the pilot group has not attended classes. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | A between-person design would need a large sample because walking speed varies. A within-person design is more efficient, but order effects become important. Half the participants must begin with the digital prompt and half with the shelf-label condition. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | Both conditions must use the same target books. The route display changes, not the item being searched for. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | Target books should be similar in size and placed at ordinary heights. A book displayed face-out or shelved incorrectly would turn the task into a search anomaly rather than a navigation comparison. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | Our primary outcome is the time to locate the target book. Questions asked and recall are useful secondary observations. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | Observers should not give hints. If someone asks whether a floor is correct, the observer repeats the task instruction but does not confirm direction. Any spontaneous help from other library users is logged. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | A coded route sheet gives observers the same categories, so they record corridor and aisle choices consistently. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | Completion time begins when the call number is handed over and ends when the participant touches the correct book. Pauses to ask questions remain part of the time because they reflect the navigation process. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | At the start of each task, the participant receives one printed call number rather than a title and cover image. |

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|---|---|
| **Crispin Penrith** | The coded path sheet divides the route into choice points. That lets us see whether an aid prevents a wrong floor, a wrong zone or only a wrong aisle. A single total time would hide those patterns. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | In the digital condition, the phone displays a location prompt with floor, zone and shelf direction. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | Accessibility should be checked before recruitment. The route must not require stairs, and the phone text must support enlargement. Those are delivery requirements, not extra experimental conditions. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | Observers mark every wrong aisle entered, even if the participant leaves it quickly. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | Finally, the debrief explains that the study evaluates information design, not individual intelligence. We delete the link between names and route data after scheduling is complete. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | After each task, a short survey asks about perceived difficulty, which may differ from measured completion time. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | I will handle the route sheet, while Crispin prepares the random order in which conditions and target books appear. |
| **Crispin Penrith** | We should also capture whether participants consult the catalogue again during the task. Rechecking may indicate uncertainty at the transition from floor information to shelf order. The digital condition must not reveal a photograph of the target shelf, because that would add a visual recognition cue absent from the printed condition. Battery level and network access are practical risks. The prompt should be stored locally on the study phone so a connection failure does not create unequal delays. Participants use the same device and text size unless an accessibility adjustment is requested and recorded. Observers require training with two example routes before collecting data. Agreement can be checked by having both code the same practice video and discussing differences in aisle and hesitation categories. If an observer misses a movement, the record should say missing rather than guessing from the final location. That approach may reduce the dataset slightly but protects the meaning of each coded choice. A short rehearsal should also confirm that the timer, route code and observer notes all refer to the same trial. That check prevents a correctly recorded walk from being attached to the wrong condition during later analysis. |
| **Eleri Snowe** | Once Crispin randomises the order, we can run two internal trials and confirm that neither condition contains an accidental clue. |

## Part 4 - academic monologue

| | |
|---|---|
| **Lecturer** | Animal navigation uses several cues, and today’s topic is one that humans do not normally notice without instruments: the polarisation pattern of skylight. It supplies directional structure even when the sun is difficult to see. |
| **Lecturer** | Direct sunlight becomes scattered by molecules in the atmosphere, creating directional information across the dome of the sky. |
| **Lecturer** | Polarisation describes the orientation of light-wave oscillation. Scattering in the sky produces a geometrical pattern related to the sun’s position. The pattern is not equally strong in every direction or weather condition. |
| **Lecturer** | That scattering produces a pattern of sky polarisation: light waves tend to oscillate in particular orientations depending on position. |

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Lecturer** | Many navigating insects have a specialised dorsal region of the compound eye. Receptors there differ in orientation, allowing the nervous system to compare responses and extract the direction of polarised light. |
| **Lecturer** | Insects detect these orientations with specialised photoreceptors, often concentrated in a particular region of the compound eye. |
| **Lecturer** | Detection is only the first step. A compass must connect the sky signal with a desired travel direction. An insect leaving a nest and one returning to it may use the same cue but choose opposite bearings. |
| **Lecturer** | Signals from those receptors are compared in neural circuits to produce a celestial compass rather than a picture of a painted line. |
| **Lecturer** | Time compensation matters because the sun and associated sky pattern appear to move. Without an internal clock, a fixed visual rule would gradually point in the wrong geographical direction during a long journey. |
| **Lecturer** | The pattern may remain useful under partial cloud cover, when the solar disc itself is not visible but portions of sky can still be sampled. |
| **Lecturer** | Experiments manipulate one cue while attempting to preserve others. A filter can rotate the polarisation pattern above an arena. Screens can hide the sun. Eye covers can remove input from selected receptors. |
| **Lecturer** | Because the sky pattern changes through the day, the insect compares direction with an internal clock to maintain a useful bearing. |
| **Lecturer** | Each manipulation has limits. A filter may alter intensity as well as orientation. A screen may leave landscape cues. An eye cover could affect general vision. Control groups are therefore essential. |
| **Lecturer** | In a rotating-filter experiment, changing the artificial polarisation axis produces a corresponding change in chosen direction. |
| **Lecturer** | Cloud is not a simple on-off switch. Thin or broken cloud may leave usable patches, while uniform dense cloud reduces the signal. Some insects then weight wind, landmarks or magnetic information more heavily. |
| **Lecturer** | A screened-sun experiment tests whether an insect can orient when the sun itself is hidden but a patch of polarised sky remains available. |
| **Lecturer** | Species also differ. A mechanism demonstrated in one insect should not automatically be assigned to all flying or walking insects. Ecology, eye structure and journey length shape which cue is useful. |
| **Lecturer** | A clock-shift experiment alters the animal's internal time, helping separate compensation by the clock from a fixed response to the visual cue. |
| **Lecturer** | The strongest conclusion comes from converging evidence: receptor anatomy, neural responses and predictable behavioural changes under controlled cue rotations. No single observation establishes the whole navigation system. |
| **Lecturer** | Covering the specialised eye region, while leaving other vision available, can confirm a role for those receptors if orientation deteriorates. |

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Lecturer** | The geometry of the polarisation pattern also creates ambiguity. A compass reading may have a one-hundred-and-eighty-degree alternative unless another cue distinguishes the two directions. The animal's travel goal, brightness gradient or landmark information can help resolve that ambiguity. Behavioural arenas simplify the sky but can introduce reflections from walls. Experiments therefore use matte surfaces and control the intensity of light while rotating only the intended axis. Outdoors, researchers may release insects from unfamiliar sites and record the initial orientation before landmarks become familiar. An initial bearing is informative, but successful navigation over a long distance involves further decisions that the first measurement does not capture. Neural recordings provide a different scale of evidence. Some cells change activity with the e-vector orientation of light, while others represent heading after several sensory inputs have been combined. Linking those signals to free behaviour remains challenging. Polarised light is best understood as one weighted input in a flexible system. When it is reliable, it can stabilise direction. When cloud or vegetation weakens it, an insect need not become completely lost if wind, odour or learnt landmarks are available. This cue integration explains why removing one source of information sometimes changes orientation strongly and sometimes has only a modest effect. Researchers should also report the weather and horizon visibility so that field results can be compared across sites. |
| **Lecturer** | Next we will examine how insects combine this celestial compass with landmarks when they approach a familiar nest site. |

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# Reading

| Question | Answer | Accepted variants |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | air ports | |
| 2 | air | |
| 3 | shaft | |
| 4 | separation chamber | |
| 5 | delivery pipe | |
| 6 | outlet | |
| 7 | moisture | |
| 8 | A | |
| 9 | C | |
| 10 | D | |
| 11 | E | |
| 12 | F | |
| 13 | G | |
| 14 | TRUE | |
| 15 | FALSE | |
| 16 | FALSE | |
| 17 | TRUE | |
| 18 | NOT GIVEN | |
| 19 | TRUE | |
| 20 | FALSE | |
| 21 | unchanging sequence | |
| 22 | formula | |
| 23 | theme | |
| 24 | written snapshot | |
| 25 | creative constraint | |
| 26 | distributed tradition | |
| 27 | E | |
| 28 | B | |

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| Question | Answer | Accepted variants |
|---|---|---|
| 29 | G | |
| 30 | A | |
| 31 | D | |
| 32 | C | |
| 33 | B | |
| 34 | D | |
| 35 | A | |
| 36 | NO | |
| 37 | YES | |
| 38 | NO | |
| 39 | NOT GIVEN | |
| 40 | NO | |

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